

## History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 28)

### Page 137 - Johnson's Works and Life

Q1. What was the name of the magazine Johnson regularly contributed parliamentary reports to?

- A. The Spectator
- B. Cave's Magazine
- C. The Tatler
- D. The Rambler

Answer: B

Q2. What tragedy did Johnson produce in 1749?

- A. Cato
- B. Irene
- C. The Campaign
- D. The Rivals

Answer: B

Q3. Which periodical did Johnson start in March 1750?

- A. The Rambler
- B. The Idler
- C. The Adventurer
- D. The Citizen of the World

Answer: A

Q4. How long did Johnson work on his 'Dictionary of the English Language'?

- A. Five years
- B. Eight years
- C. Ten years
- D. Twelve years

Answer: B

Q5. To whom did Johnson write a magnificent letter that dealt a deathblow to the system of patronage?

- A. Lord Shaftesbury
- B. Lord Bolingbroke

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C. Lord Chesterfield

D. Horace Walpole

Answer: C

Q6. What title did Smollett give to Johnson?

A. The King of Letters

B. The Great Cham of literature

C. The Literary Dictator

D. The Master Critic

Answer: B

Q7. When did Johnson publish his didactic tale, 'Rasselas'?

A. 1755

B. 1759

C. 1765

D. 1775

Answer: B

Q8. What is the title of Johnson's largest and greatest work published in 1779-81?

A. Lives of the Most Eminent English Poets

B. Journey to the Western Islands

C. The Rambler

D. The Vanity of Human Wishes

Answer: A

Q9. Where was Johnson buried?

A. St. Paul's Cathedral

B. Westminster Abbey

C. Lichfield Cathedral

D. Highgate Cemetery

Answer: B

Q10. Who said 'the memory of other authors is kept alive by their works, but the memory of Johnson keeps

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many of his works alive'?

- A. Boswell
- B. Macaulay
- C. Smollett
- D. Garrick

Answer: B

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### Page 138 - Johnson as Critic and Moralist

Q1. Who is Johnson's hero-worshipping biographer?

- A. David Garrick
- B. James Boswell
- C. Oliver Goldsmith
- D. Joshua Reynolds

Answer: B

Q2. What was Johnson's general attitude as a critic of literature?

- A. Revolutionary
- B. Romantic
- C. Conservative
- D. Liberal

Answer: C

Q3. Whose poetry did Johnson fail to appreciate due to antipathy towards his politics and religion?

- A. Spenser
- B. Shakespeare
- C. Milton
- D. Pope

Answer: C

Q4. Which school of poetry did Johnson hold fast to?

- A. The Augustan school
- B. The Romantic school
- C. The Metaphysical school
- D. The Cavalier school

Answer: A

Q5. Broadly speaking, Johnson's philosophy was that of a...

- A. Optimist
- B. Pessimist

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C. Pragmatist

D. Utilitarian

Answer: B

Q6. Which work is an adaptation of the tenth satire of Juvenal?

A. Rasselas

B. The Vanity of Human Wishes

C. London

D. Irene

Answer: B

Q7. 'Rasselas' is historically significant as a reply to the flimsy optimism of...

A. Swift and Defoe

B. Shaftesbury and Pope

C. Addison and Steele

D. Milton and Dryden

Answer: B

Q8. The protagonist of 'Rasselas' is a young prince from...

A. Persia

B. Abyssinia

C. Egypt

D. India

Answer: B

Q9. As a moralist, Johnson is characterized by remarkable...

A. Cynicism and doubt

B. Sanity and massive commonsense

C. Mysticism and romance

D. Emotional excess

Answer: B

Q10. In his major works, Johnson's conclusions show he was saved from hopelessness by his...

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- A. Strong religious faith
- B. Financial success
- C. Literary fame
- D. Friends and club

Answer: A

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### Page 139 - Johnson's Prose and Goldsmith's Early Life

Q1. What did Macaulay call Johnson's prose style?

- A. Augustan prose
- B. Johnsonese
- C. Latinized English
- D. Neo-classic style

Answer: B

Q2. Johnson's style is highly Latinized in vocabulary and marked in sentence structure by...

- A. Short and punchy phrases
- B. Colloquial idioms
- C. Elaborate balance and antithesis
- D. Stream of consciousness

Answer: C

Q3. Where was Oliver Goldsmith born?

- A. Dublin, Ireland
- B. Pallas, Co. Longford, Ireland
- C. London, England
- D. Edinburgh, Scotland

Answer: B

Q4. What profession did Goldsmith ostensibly go to Edinburgh and Leyden to study?

- A. Law
- B. Theology
- C. Medicine
- D. Literature

Answer: C

Q5. In 1755, Goldsmith set out to make the Grand Tour of Europe equipped with one clean shirt, a guinea, and a...

- A. Walking stick

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- B. German flute
- C. Set of medical instruments
- D. Volume of poetry

Answer: B

Q6. From which of Goldsmith's novels can we learn about his continental wanderings?

- A. Robinson Crusoe
- B. The Vicar of Wakefield
- C. Rasselas
- D. Tom Jones

Answer: B

Q7. Which poem by Goldsmith is also thought to reflect his European experiences?

- A. The Deserted Village
- B. The Traveller
- C. London
- D. The Vanity of Human Wishes

Answer: B

Q8. In what year did Goldsmith reach London penniless and friendless?

- A. 1750
- B. 1755
- C. 1756
- D. 1760

Answer: C

Q9. After arriving in London, Goldsmith acted as an assistant to an...

- A. Apothecary
- B. Attorney
- C. Actor
- D. Architect

Answer: A



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Q10. At what age did Goldsmith drift into literature?

- A. Twenty
- B. Twenty-five
- C. Thirty
- D. Thirty-five

Answer: C

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### Page 140 - Goldsmith's Works and Character

Q1. Much of Goldsmith's literary output belongs to the class popularly known as...

- A. Masterpieces
- B. Epics
- C. 'Pot-boilers'
- D. Memoirs

Answer: C

Q2. Which of the following is a poem by Goldsmith?

- A. The Deserted Village
- B. The Rape of the Lock
- C. The Dunciad
- D. Essay on Man

Answer: A

Q3. What is the title of Goldsmith's one novel?

- A. Rasselas
- B. The Vicar of Wakefield
- C. Pamela
- D. Joseph Andrews

Answer: B

Q4. Which of the following is a comedy by Goldsmith?

- A. Cato
- B. The Conscious Lovers
- C. She Stoops to Conquer
- D. The Rivals

Answer: C

Q5. What was the title of Goldsmith's series of essays?

- A. The Rambler
- B. The Citizen of the World

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C. The Idler

D. The Spectator

Answer: B

Q6. Who said of Goldsmith that he 'wrote like an angel' but 'talked like poor Poll'?

A. Johnson

B. Boswell

C. Garrick

D. Burke

Answer: C

Q7. How did Johnson describe Goldsmith in his Latin epitaph?

A. A fierce satirist

B. A gentle master who touched nothing that he did not adorn

C. The greatest poet of his time

D. A tragic genius

Answer: B

Q8. Though Johnson often bullied Goldsmith, what did he not allow?

A. Goldsmith to write tragedy

B. Anyone else to bully him

C. Goldsmith to leave the club

D. Boswell to speak to him

Answer: B

Q9. When did Goldsmith die?

A. 1770

B. 1774

C. 1780

D. 1784

Answer: B

Q10. What state was Goldsmith in when he died?

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- A. Deeply in debt
- B. Extremely wealthy
- C. Politically powerful
- D. Exiled from England

Answer: A

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### Page 141 - Goldsmith's Drama and Prose Style

Q1. Goldsmith's comedies mark a reaction against...

- A. Heroic Tragedy
- B. Sentimental Comedy
- C. Farce
- D. Romantic Comedy

Answer: B

Q2. Who was Goldsmith's fellow-countryman that also played an equal part in reviving the true comic spirit?

- A. Richard Brinsley Sheridan
- B. David Garrick
- C. Colley Cibber
- D. Richard Steele

Answer: A

Q3. Which of the following is a comedy by Sheridan?

- A. She Stoops to Conquer
- B. The School for Scandal
- C. The Good-Natured Man
- D. The Conscious Lovers

Answer: B

Q4. A striking feature of Goldsmith's original writings is the strong...

- A. Political allegory
- B. Personal element
- C. Religious doctrine
- D. Philosophical detachment

Answer: B

Q5. Dr. Primrose in 'The Vicar of Wakefield' is modeled after Goldsmith's...

- A. Brother
- B. Father

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- C. Uncle
- D. Grandfather

Answer: B

Q6. The good priest in 'The Deserted Village' is modeled after Goldsmith's...

- A. Brother Henry
- B. Father
- C. Friend Johnson
- D. Self

Answer: A

Q7. Moses, young Honeywood, and Tony Lumpkin are humorous studies of...

- A. David Garrick
- B. Samuel Johnson
- C. James Boswell
- D. Goldsmith himself

Answer: D

Q8. Though Goldsmith keeps near to actual life, he is in no sense a...

- A. Realist
- B. Romanticist
- C. Moralist
- D. Humorist

Answer: A

Q9. Everything Goldsmith takes out of experience undergoes what in his hands?

- A. Satirisation
- B. Idealisation
- C. Dramatisation
- D. Falsification

Answer: B

Q10. In his prose style, Goldsmith carried on the traditions of...

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- A. Johnson and Boswell
- B. Swift and Pope
- C. Addison and Steele
- D. Dryden and Milton

Answer: C